

Kalshiman

Operator guide - run a bot on your own account, paper first, and watch small wins compound

For the people who run the bots: get a return on limited funds and see real growth day over day

August 20, 2026

1. What you are running

Kalshiman is a bot for Kalshi, the regulated prediction market. Every 15 minutes, markets ask a simple yes/no question - will gold be up in the next 15 minutes? - and the favorite is usually priced at 90-98 cents. The bot buys the favorite only when the setup is near-certain, banks the win at 99.5 cents, and walks away. It is paper by default: the bot proves a rule on simulated money before any real dollar is at risk.

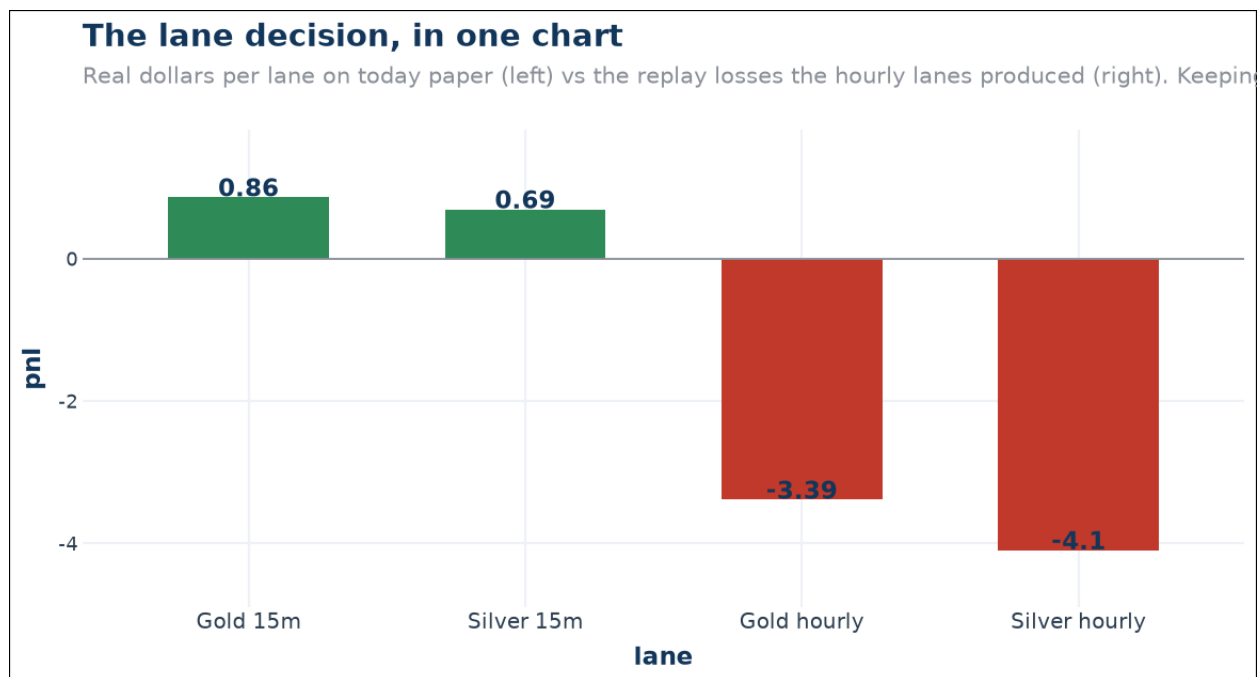


Figure 1 - the lane decision: real dollars today (left) vs the replay losses the cut lanes produced (right)

The engine also includes a precision perps dip bot (paper-first) that trades crypto perps only when a real trend dips deep enough to clear fees. Both systems log every decision, including every setup they refuse, so you can always see why a trade did or did not happen.

2. Getting started

Step 1 - make a Kalshi account and load a little cash. The easiest route is login with Google on kalshi.com. Kalshi is not available in all US states, so confirm yours is eligible first. You need an API key for the bot: account settings, API, create key, and save the key ID plus private key file.

Step 2 - install the app (the desktop exe) or run the headless watcher. The app walks you through setup, webhooks, and live mode. Power users run the watcher directly:

```
node scripts/watch-headless.js
```

The watcher writes its state to `memory/headless-state.json` and posts summaries to your Discord webhook channels.

Step 3 - open the dashboard at <http://127.0.0.1:8788> to watch decisions, charts, and accuracy in real time.

Step 4 - run the perps dip bot in paper mode alongside it:

```
node scripts/perps-v2-watcher.js --paper
```

Start paper. Flip live only after the paper record is boring: consistent wins, tiny losses, no surprises.

3. What a day looks like

A typical day on paper (real Kalshi markets, this week): 59 trades, 52 wins, 7 losses, +\$1.57 on \$1-3 paper stakes. The wins are small and frequent - 2 to 11 cents each - and the losses are capped at 8-16 cents. The daily summary webhook arrives each evening with today P&L, win rate, prediction accuracy, and a per-strategy breakdown, so the growth is visible day over day.

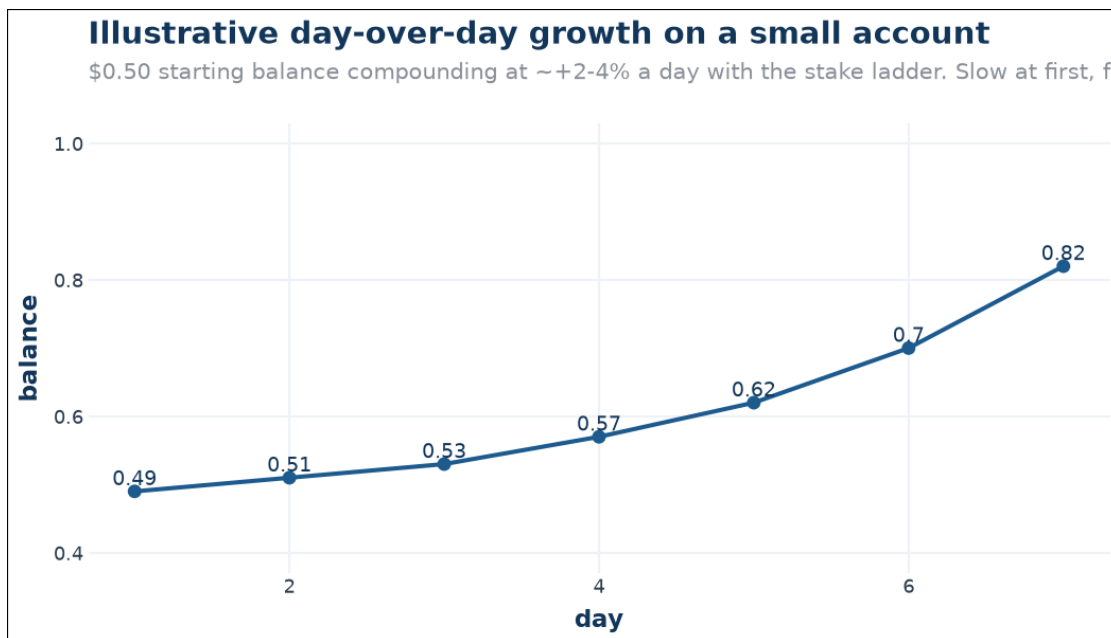


Figure 2 - illustrative day-over-day growth on a small account

On a small account the first days look unimpressive - cents, not dollars. That is the compounding phase working as intended: the stake ladder waits until \$200-300 is banked as backing before positions get meaningful, because at that point the same wins stop being cents and start being dollars.

4. Your money

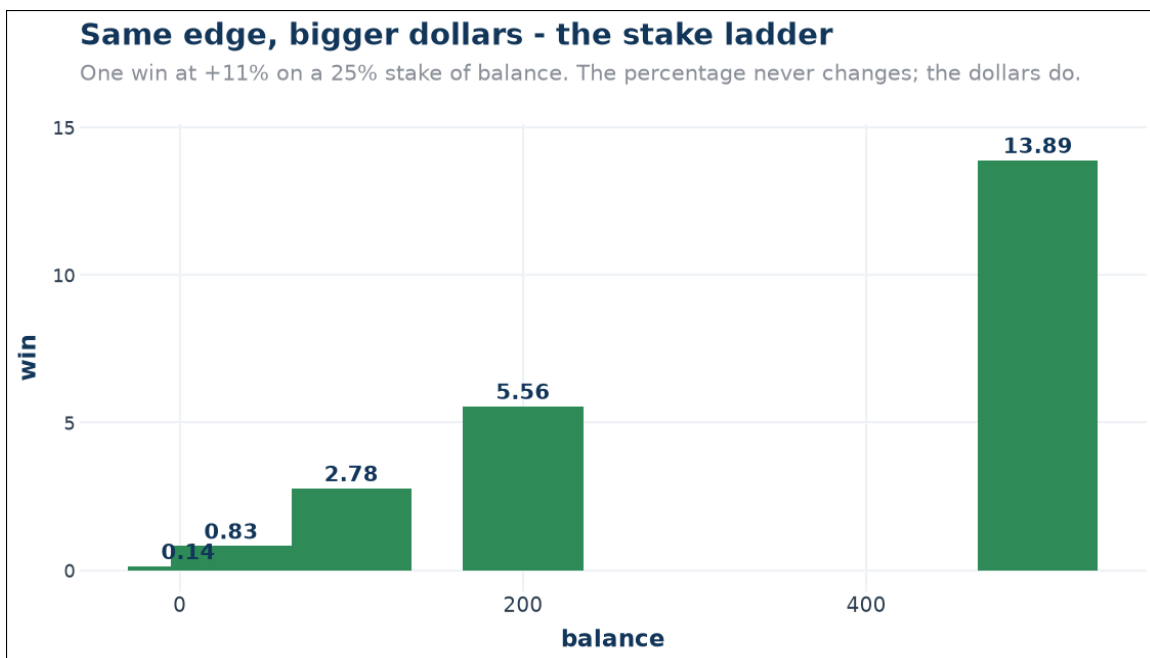


Figure 3 - same edge, bigger dollars: one win at each balance level

Your balance	Stake (25%)	One win	One capped stop
\$5	\$1.25	+\$0.14	-\$0.11
\$30	\$7.50	+\$0.83	-\$0.67
\$100	\$25	+\$2.78	-\$2.22
\$200	\$50	+\$5.56	-\$4.44
\$500	\$125	+\$13.89	-\$11.11

Fees are the one cost to respect: about 0.63c per contract on entry, roughly 1.26c round trip. The fee gate is the reason the bot skips shallow setups - a dip that cannot clear fees three times over is a trade that loses by math. You never pay for a setup the bot refuses.

5. Safety rails - built in, not optional

No martingale, no revenge trading, no leverage beyond a hard cap, and a daily loss breaker that stops new entries for the day after -\$0.50 on the perps lane. Every live position has a stop, and the final-minute escape hatch caps the rare wrong call at a fixed width. Paper mode is the default; live mode is a deliberate switch, not an accident.

The block log is a feature: when the bot refuses a setup, it records the reason (flat tape, fee eats edge, LLM disagreed). A bot that says no is the bot that does not bleed. The v1 version traded every flat tape and paid fees on noise; the rework exists because of that mistake, and the rails exist so it cannot happen twice.

6. The network - your bot gets smarter

Workers share what they learn through the pool: a worker that proves a signal posts it, other workers verify and credit it, and everyone ends up with the same winning information. The network is how a small account on one machine becomes part of a fleet that covers many markets. Your bot keeps its own account and its own money; the pool shares information, not funds.

7. Resources

Resource	Where
Kalshi account	kalshi.com - login with Google; API key in account settings
Full breakdown PDF	docs/kalshiman-full-breakdown.pdf - how the engine works, all 19 chapters
This guide	docs/kalshiman-consumer-guide.pdf
Investor brief	docs/kalshiman-investor-brief.pdf - the numbers and the network economics
Docs repository	github.com/unaveragetechnology/kalshiman-docs
Live dashboard	http://127.0.0.1:8788 - charts, accuracy, decisions
Event watcher	<code>node scripts/watch-headless.js</code>
Perps dip bot	<code>node scripts/perps-v2-watcher.js --paper</code>
State + logs	<code>memory/headless-state.json</code> , <code>memory/perps-v2.log</code> , <code>memory/overnight-log.md</code>

Start small. Paper first. Let the compounding do the loud part - it is the whole design.

You bring the account and the patience. The bot brings the edge and the discipline.
Cents become dollars the moment the balance is banked enough to step the stake up.